Training · Module 02 · Fri 13 Nov

The discovery call.

You are a doctor, not a salesman. You diagnose where the business is losing money, show the owner the number, and only then prescribe. Thirty minutes, and you talk 30% of the time.

Time: 1 hour read + role-play with the CEO (pass mark 16/20)

Pairs with playbook section 06

01 · MINDSET

Developers lose discovery calls in one specific way.

You know how to build everything, so the instinct is to explain features: "we'll use Flutter, real-time tracking, admin dashboard…". The owner hears noise. What they want to hear is that you understood their business and their money.

Developer instinct	Do this instead
Explain the tech stack.	Ask how orders come in today.
Agree to every feature they mention.	Ask "what does that feature save or earn you?" and park the ones with no answer for Phase 2.
Fill silence with talking.	Count to three. The owner fills it with the real problem.
Quote a price at the end to "close" the call.	Promise a branded demo in 48 hours and book the walkthrough slot.
Accept "it's for my town" as the business case.	Ask "who will be your first 100 customers, and how will they hear about it?"

The 30-minute structure

Block	Goal	Your key line
Open · 2 min	Set the agenda and permission to be honest.	"I'll understand your business, show you where an app makes or saves money, and tell you honestly if it doesn't. Okay?"
Today · 8 min	How the business actually runs: orders, volume, people, tools.	"Walk me through yesterday: from the first order to the last delivery."
The leak · 8 min	Find the cost in rupees, hours or lost customers.	"What does that cost you in a month?"
Payback · 5 min	Do the maths live, with their numbers.	"So roughly ₹__ a month is leaking. Let's see how long an app takes to pay back."
Decision · 4 min	Budget, decision-maker, launch date.	"Who else will be part of the decision? When do you want to launch?"
Next step · 3 min	Book the walkthrough before you hang up.	"Give me 48 hours for a demo with your brand on it. Thursday, 7 or 8 pm?"

Opening in Marathi: "आज मी तुमचा business समजून घेईन, app मधून पैसे कुठे वाचतील किंवा वाढतील ते दाखवेन, आणि app ची गरज नसेल तर तसंही स्पष्ट सांगेन. चालेल?"

02 · QUESTION BANK

Questions by segment. Pick 6–8, not all of them.

Segment	Today	The leak
Distributor / wholesaler	How many retailers? How do they order: salesman, phone, WhatsApp? How many orders a day? What billing software (Tally, Busy, Marg)?	How many wrong or missed orders a week? How much outstanding credit right now? How many hours do staff spend typing orders? Do retailers know your schemes?
Restaurant / sweet shop	Outlets? Orders a month on Zomato/Swiggy? Average order value? Do you have your own delivery boys?	Monthly commission + ads spend? How many customers are repeat regulars? What happens on festival days?
Supermarket / kirana chain	Outlets? Do customers already order on WhatsApp or phone? Delivery radius? Billing software?	How many orders get missed or wrong? Has a quick-commerce app reached your town yet? Who are your top 200 families?
Marketplace founder	Who are the sellers and buyers? How many have you already spoken to? What's your capital and runway?	Why will a seller list with you instead of selling directly? What does your first month in one area look like? How do you earn: commission, fees, delivery?
Booking / services	How are bookings taken today? How many providers? Cancellations and no-shows?	How many enquiries never become bookings? How much time goes on calls and reminders?

Four listening tools

Tell me more	"याबद्दल अजून सांगा." The single most useful sentence in sales. Use it on every complaint.
Mirror	Repeat their last 2–3 words as a question. Owner: "Retailers just don't pay on time." You: "Don't pay on time?" They will explain the real problem.
Put a number on it	Every pain gets a number: "Roughly how many a week? What is one of those worth?"
Summarise	Before payback maths: "So orders come on WhatsApp, about 8 a week go wrong, and ₹4 lakh is pending with retailers. Did I get that right?" A yes here is the first yes of the sale.

Payback maths, done live

Restaurant
₹4L/month on aggregators × ~25% commission and ads ≈ ₹1L/month leaving.
Move 30% of orders to your own app → ≈ ₹30k/month saved.
₹1.5L app ÷ ₹30k ≈ **5 months to pay back.**

Distributor
₹50L/month sales. Faster reorders and reminders lift repeat orders 3% → ₹1.5L more sales a month.
At a ~10% margin, ≈ ₹15k/month more profit, plus staff hours saved.
₹2L app ≈ **pays back within a year**, often faster.

Always use their numbers, and round down. Owners trust conservative maths. If the payback is longer than 12 months, say so honestly and suggest the Launch tier, or say the app isn't worth it yet. That honesty is what makes the next owner trust you.

03 · PRACTICE

Role-plays and the scorecard.

Type "Role-play: [scenario]" to the CEO in chat. I'll play the owner. You write exactly what you'd say. After the call I score you on the rubric below.

#	Scenario	What the owner will do
1	Pharma distributor, Nashik, 400 retailers	Friendly but vague. Says "everything is fine, just want to modernise." Your job: find the real leak.
2	3-outlet sweet shop, Sangli	Keeps asking "how much?" from minute two. Your job: hold the price until the payback maths.
3	Spare parts marketplace founder, Pune	Wants B2B + B2C + pan-India from day one, and a low price. Your job: phase it and keep him excited.
4	Agri input marketplace founder	Unclear whether it's for dealers or farmers. Your job: get him to choose one for Phase 1.

Scorecard (20 points, pass at 16)

Behaviour	Points	What full marks looks like
Clear opening and agenda	2	Permission line said in the first minute.
Talk ratio under 40%	3	Mostly questions; no feature lectures.
Found the leak in rupees	4	At least one pain with a monthly ₹ number attached.
Payback maths with their numbers	3	Conservative, explained simply, and the owner agreed.
Budget, decision-maker and timing confirmed	3	All three asked directly.
Scope controlled	2	Extra ideas parked for Phase 2 without killing excitement.
Next step booked with a date and time	3	Walkthrough slot fixed before hanging up.

After every real call (5 minutes)

☐ Write in the tracker: the leak in ₹, the payback number, decision-maker, launch date, next step and date.

☐ Send the confirmation WhatsApp within an hour: "Thanks __ ji. As discussed: [leak]. I'll send your demo by [day] and we'll walk through it at [time]."

☐ Score yourself on the rubric. Send me the score and the weakest behaviour in the nightly report.

Pass mark: 16/20 on any two role-plays with me before your first real discovery call this weekend.